STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			AU-9300
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 11/17/14	DATE REVISED **03/12/24**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE AUXILIARY UNITS: CRASH RESPONSE UNIT	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT CRU OPERATIONS AND TRAINING	CROSS-REFERENCE P-4000 TRAFFIC ACCIDENT INVESTIGATION P-4010 SERIOUS PERSONAL INJURY AND FATALITY CRASHES			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish guidelines for Crash Response Unit operations during deployments and training.

II. Policy:

The Crash Response Unit (CRU), comprised of sworn personnel, is designed to provide a twenty-four (24) hour response to critical injury and fatality crashes. The CRU shall function under all policies and procedures established for the Sheriff's Office. The operations of the CRU, including training, shall be controlled by policy and procedure and shall be closely supervised by the CRU Commander and CRU Team Leader.

III. Procedure:

A. Training: Deputies assigned to the CRU shall receive appropriate specialized training on an annual basis. The training program may be coordinated in conjunction with the South Metro Crash Response Team (SMCRT) and its bi-annual training. In addition, the CRU Commander may require CRU deputies to attend additional training, separate from the SMCRT.

1. Deputies on the Crash Response Unit are required to attend, at a minimum, the Intermediate Crash Investigation course (40 hours) and the Advanced Crash Investigation course (40 hours).

2. Deputies are encouraged to attend the Technical Crash Investigation course (80 hours) and the Crash Reconstructionist course (80 hours). Deputies shall request approval to attend these courses from the CRU Commander and the Team Leader, who shall consider the following:

a) The deputy's response to callouts and assisting with follow-up

investigations.

b) The deputy's ability to conduct comprehensive investigations and reconstructions.

3. As part of CRU training, equipment owned and stored by the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office Crash Response Unit shall be inspected at least quarterly to ensure proper functionality and up-to-date software.

B. **Operations:** During deployments, the CRU Team Leader or designee shall oversee and direct the unit.

1. Any time the CRU is deployed, the ADC shall be notified by the on-duty patrol supervisor.

a) If the CRU is utilized by an outside agency that is not part of SMCRT, the CRU Commander and ADC shall be notified by the CRU Team Leader.

2. When deployed for an incident, CRU deputies shall respond to the crash scene within a reasonable amount of time. CRU deputies are encouraged to retrieve a marked patrol unit to respond to the crash scene. In some instances, it is acceptable for CRU deputies to respond in their personal vehicles to crash scenes if retrieving a marked patrol unit will substantially delay response to a crash scene.

a) CRU deputies shall ensure the Unit's assigned vehicle and equipment is retrieved prior to requesting to take his/her personal vehicle to a crash scene

b) If a CRU deputy is unable to respond to a callout, he or she shall email the CRU Commander and CRU Team Leader to inform both individuals of the reason of the absence.

3. When conducting CRU operations, the following procedures shall be adhered to:

a) One deputy of the CRU will assume the Primary Crash Investigator.

(1) If a CRU deputy is on-duty and working a Road Patrol district, that deputy shall assume control of the crash scene. The CRU deputy shall contact the CRU Team Leader to determine the need for the CRU and/or SMCRT.

b) Deputies on the CRU shall work together to collect evidence including, but not limited to, measurements, photographs, and other short-lived scene evidence.

c) CRU deputies shall wear a reflective traffic vest when conducting an investigation at a crash scene.

d) CRU deputies shall adhere to policies P-4000 Traffic Accident Investigation and P-4010 Serious Personal Injury and Fatality Crashes when investigating crashes.

4. At the conclusion of the incident the CRU Commander/Supervisor shall notify the ADC that the incident/deployment is over. The CRU Commander/Supervisor shall provide the ADC with the details surrounding the incident.

5. Upon completion of the on-scene investigation, the Primary Crash Investigator shall be responsible for completing any necessary follow-up investigation including, but not limited to, tow lot vehicle inspection, interviews, subpoena records, attending autopsies, and completing the reconstruction report and diagram. The report and diagram shall be completed in a timely manner and forwarded to the CRU Team Leader for review. Once reviewed by the CRU Team Leader and approved, the report will be forwarded by the Primary Crash Investigator to the Sarpy County Attorney's Office for filing of charges, if necessary.

a) If there will be a delay in completing the report, a CRU deputy must notify the CRU Team Leader and County Attorney's Office and explain the reason for the delay.

b) CRU deputies may be assigned tasks by the CRU Team Leader to assist the Primary Crash Investigator on his/her case.

c) CRU deputies shall complete supplemental reports to document his/her involvement in follow-up investigation relating to a serious injury or fatality crash.

6. Deputies on the CRU who are active and receive "Specialty Pay", as governed by the F.O.P. Lodge #3 Sworn Contract (Article 21, Section 5) for being Accident Reconstructionists shall be present at 80% of callouts for a continuous 6-month period.

a) A missed callout for a previously scheduled period of absence from work in which the CRU deputy has notified the CRU Team Leader will not count against the CRU deputy.

b) If a CRU deputy has a more than 20% unexcused absence rate from callouts, the CRU Team Leader will notify the CRU Commander.

c) The CRU Commander and CRU Team Leader will meet to determine the appropriate course of action. The CRU Commander and CRU Team

Leader may elect for to initiate a Performance Improvement Plan (P.I.P.) or submit a memorandum to the Sheriff to remove the CRU deputies from the Crash Response Unit.

d) The CRU Commander and the Team Leader shall periodically evaluate each deputy's status on the CRU based on the following:

(1) Response to callouts and assisting with follow-up investigations.

(2) Ability to conduct comprehensive investigations and reconstructions.

e) For the purposes of this section, "Accident Reconstructionists" are those CRU deputies who have complete crash investigation coursework through the "Reconstruction" level.

C. **Uniforms and Equipment:** Only equipment and clothing authorized by the CRU Commander shall be used or worn.